

festival Culture Rich

CHENNAI A blend of the traditional and the modern, the city celebrates this unique charm in its annual festival, Chennai Sangamam. Presented by the NGO Tamil Maiyam and the state Department of Tourism and Culture, the festival will feature performances showcasing different folk art forms such as *mayilattam*

(peacock dance), *maan kombattam* (deer dance) and *kalari-payittu* (martial dance).

Folk traditions are dying, as only a handful of singers have survived the onslaught of modern entertainment. The festival is an attempt to remind us of the rich art forms of India. There is also a lavish offering of Carnatic music, with performances by Ravi Kiran (gottu gadiyam), Ganesh-Kumaresh (violin) and vocalists T.M. Krishna, Bombay Jayashri, Sudha Raghunathan, Aruna

Sairam, Sikkil Gurucharan, Sangitha Sivakumar and O.S. Arun. Special dance dramas like *Valli Thirumanam* and *Pavalakodi* will be staged near the Kapaleeshwarar temple in Mylapore along with plays by Koothupattarai, Magic Lantern, Mangai and Pralayan at other locations.

This festival is not restricted to the cultural. Most of the performances will be held on the streets, railway stations, bus terminals, shopping plazas, churches and temples. In an attempt at reaching out to one and all, accomplished artistes will train school students. For film buffs, there will be a

missed retrospective of Tamil films such as *Parasakti* and *Thevar Magan*. Listen to a special Chennai Sangamam anthem penned by lyricist Vairamuthu with music by music director Deva. The finale will be a cultural gathering at Marina Beach. On till January 16.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

GIREESH GV



MUSICAL BEST: Ganesh-Kumaresh (above); Raghunathan

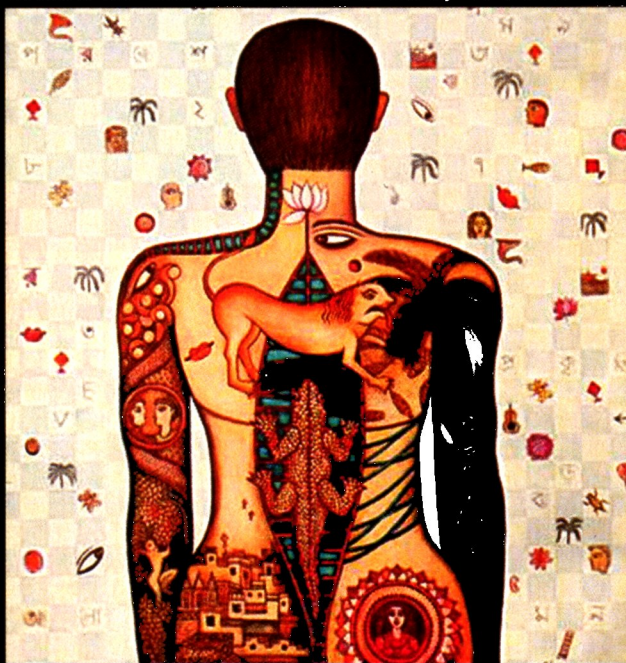


exhibition Synchronous Colours

MUMBAI Synchrome 4 is an exhibition by 86 artists, in which works of senior artists like Somnath Hore and Paritosh Sen will be juxtaposed with young names like Indrapramit Roy and Uday Mondal. The collection features a varied range of sculptures and paintings by veterans Jogen Chowdhury and Gopal Ghose, while new artists like Sarbari Roychowdhury, Alex Stenghal and Peter Bjork also create a niche in sculpting and photography. In collaboration with the Kolkata-based gallery Akar Prakar, it also features a large number of artists from east India and other parts of the country. On at the Tao Art Gallery, January 14-30.

by Swati Mathur

UNION: The exhibition features works by 86 artists



art Creative Space

DELHI Nagji Patel's exhibition is his first solo one since the mid-1990s and will provide an insight into his oeuvre, a large body of work over 30 years. Also on display is his most recent art, which has never been displayed

earlier. Baroda-based Patel's works are influenced by the rural

setting that he grew up in. His art is an ode to his village upbringing and he holds on to motifs of rustic life where religion and spirituality are at the very core of one's being. On at Gallery Espace from January 18 to February 8.

Patel's rustic work

